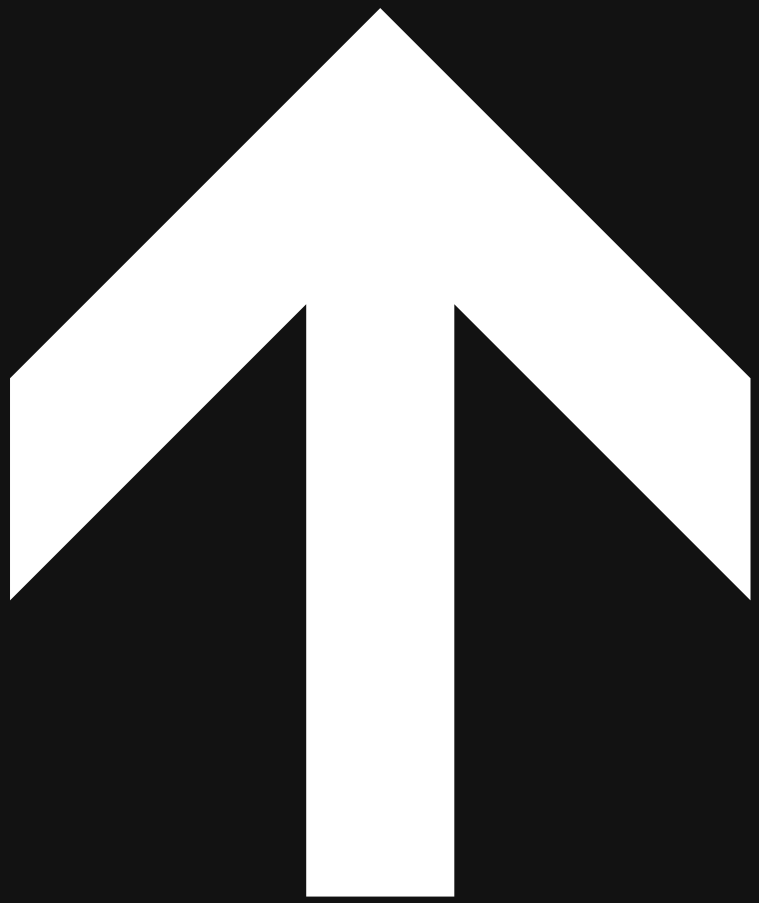
दिल्ली मेट्रो के संकेत और स्क्रीन
Delhi Metro signs and screens

Standards manual



Concept proposal. Not a DMRC document.

Signal, by Ayushman Bharadwaj · 2026

Contents

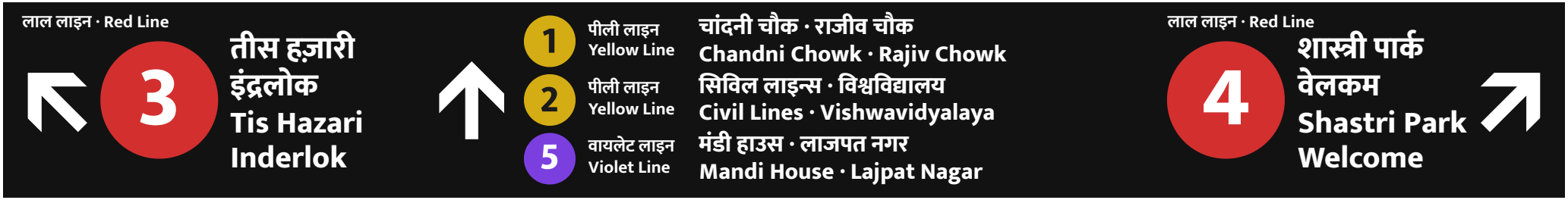
Foundations	3
Street entrance	10
Ticket hall	11
Gate	14
Concourse	15
Stairs	17
Platform	18
In the train	24
Interchange	25
Exits	27
When things go wrong	29
Limits	33

A concept proposal for how Delhi Metro's signs and screens could work as one system, from the street to the exit.

The book follows a rider through the station. 1u means 40 mm.

Check on site marks a number or fact to confirm.

One system



Near-black matte panels, with line colour used only for platforms.

Every sign answers the same questions: which way, which platform, which stops.

Hindi and English always appear together, at the same size.

Colour

Panel

#121212

Exit only

#1e7b3a

Alert only

#ffc400

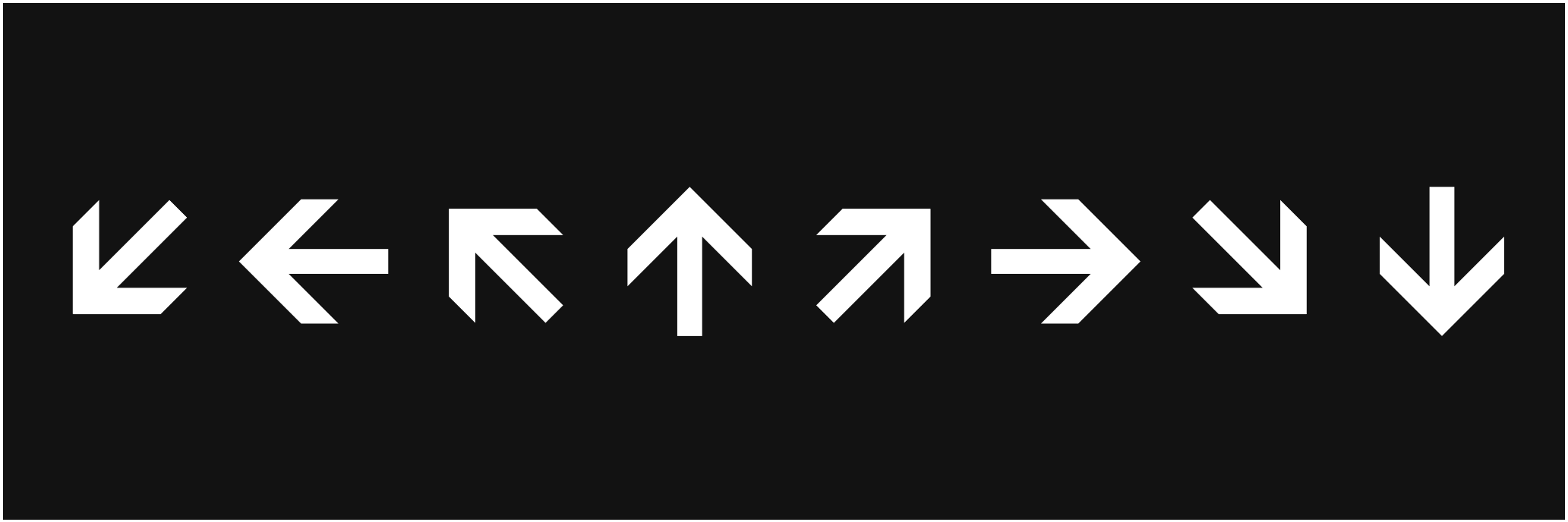


Line colour appears only as a platform circle or a line bar.

Green is kept for exits, and yellow for alerts.

Blue and Magenta circles get a white ring on black.

Arrow



One AIGA/DOT master arrow, rotated in 45° steps.

Height is 40% of the panel: 6u on a 15u panel.

Outer edge of the sign, with no box around it.

Type

Type by viewing distance

Role	Sample	Size	Height	Reads from	Used for
Platform number	5	6.6u	169 mm	68 m	Inside the circle
Gate	गेट 3 · Gate 3	3.2u	81 mm	32 m	Exit signs
Destinations	लाजपत नगर · Lajpat Nagar	2.4u	60 mm	24 m	Main names, stacked
Compact names	मंडी हाउस · Mandi House	1.8u	45 mm	18 m	Rows on a fork
Line name	वायलेट लाइन · Violet Line	1.35u	34 mm	14 m	Beside every circle
Official term	Pink Line Circular (–)	1u	25 mm	10 m	Smallest text allowed

Height is the capital letter on a 600 mm panel. Distance uses 25 mm per 10 m, a rule of thumb to confirm on site. Sizes step by about 4:3.

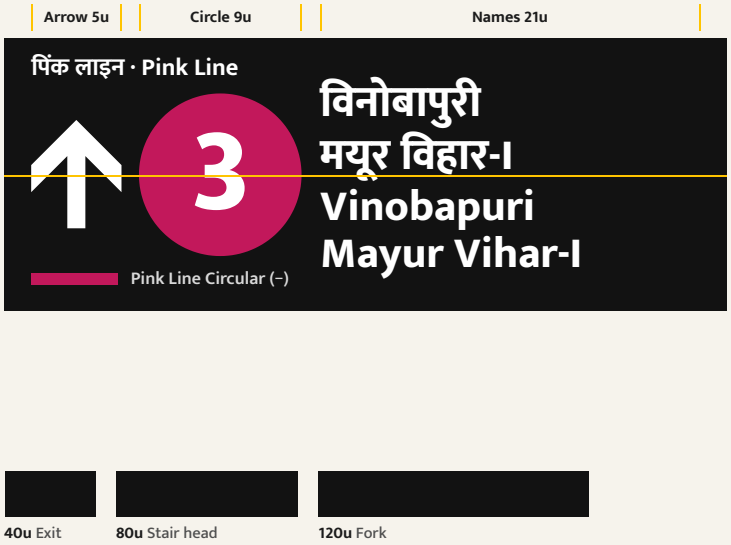
Mukta throughout, weights 500 to 800.

Hindi and English are the same size.

Line spacing is 1.2 for Hindi and 1.1 for English.

Grid

Sign grid



Module	1u is 40 mm on the wall and 20 px on these boards.
Panel height	Always 15u, or 600 mm. One height across a station.
Panel width	Steps of 40u: 40u for one decision, 80u for two, 120u for a fork.
Centre line	Arrow and circle centre on the panel's middle. Names sit 0.5u lower to clear the line name.
Margin	1.5u from every edge.
Gaps	1u between arrow, circle and names.
Same parts	Arrow is 6u tall and the circle is 9u, on every panel.

1u is 40 mm. Panel height is 15u, or 600 mm.

Widths step in 40u. Margins are 1.5u and gaps 1u.

The arrow is 6u tall and the platform circle 9u.

Check on site 600 mm panel height, against real DMRC panels.

Pictograms



Drawn on the same grid as the arrow.

Every symbol carries a Hindi and English label.

Not yet tested for comprehension. ISO 9186 is the method to use.

Hardware and light



Matte black face, with no edge or frame.

Push-through aluminium. Only the letters glow, at about 100 cd/m^2.

Hung on two slim rods.

Check on site 2.4 m lowest edge is a TfL figure.

Street entrance

Street totem

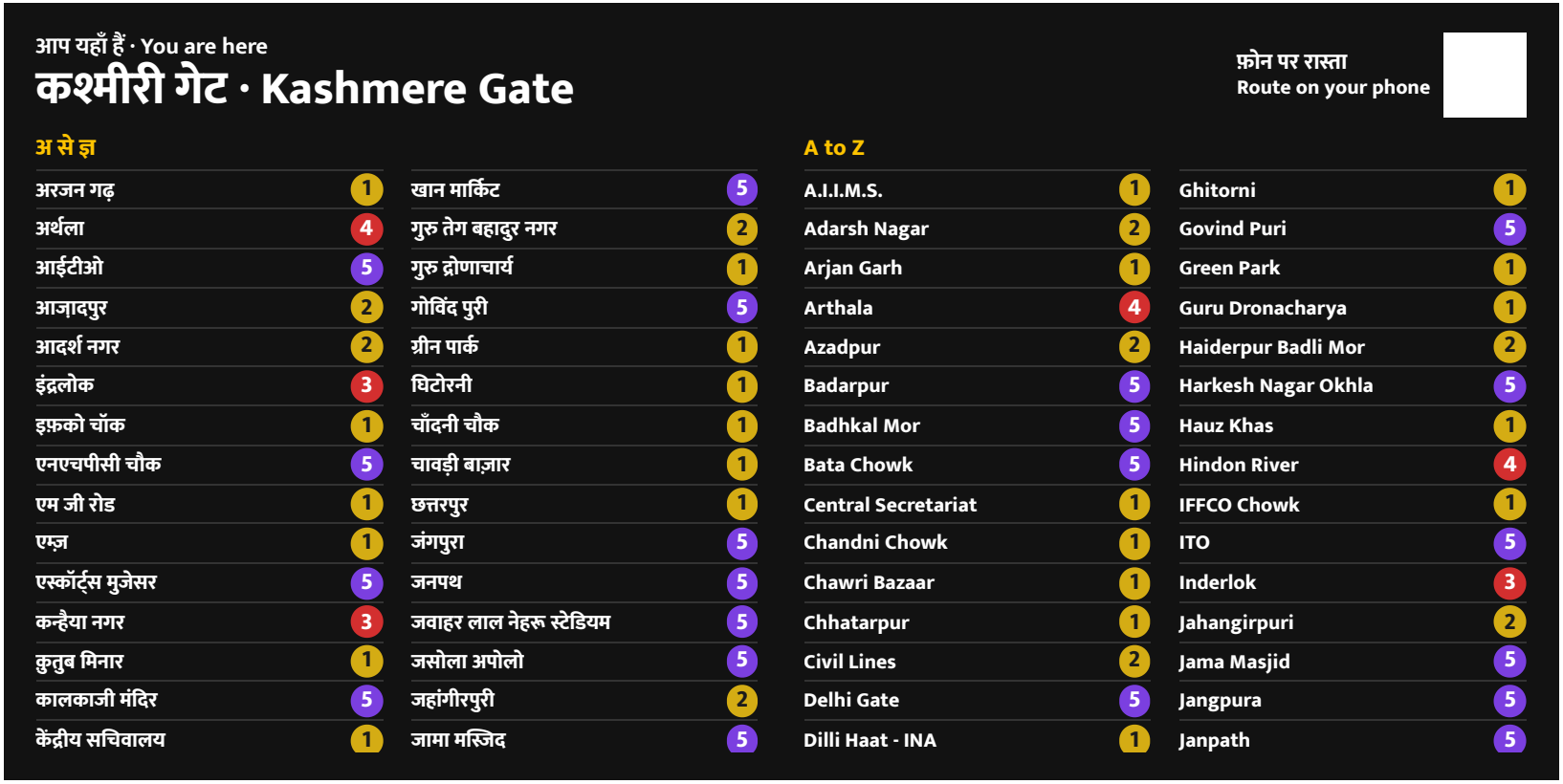


Station name, lines and gate number only.

Colour bars for lines. Circles stay for platforms.

A big gate number, with the metro train symbol on top.

Ticket hall board



Two lists: Hindi order and A to Z.

Mounted at eye level on replaceable strips.

No map. A small QR opens the route on a phone.

Check on site Lists need real routing before use.

Ticket hall

Station finder kiosk





Portrait totem, with controls in the lower half.

Common trips first, then type a station.

One big answer. Voice starts from a physical button.

Paper ticket, actual size







Black only, on today's 58 mm roll and printer.

Platform, line and the sign's two stations for each ride.

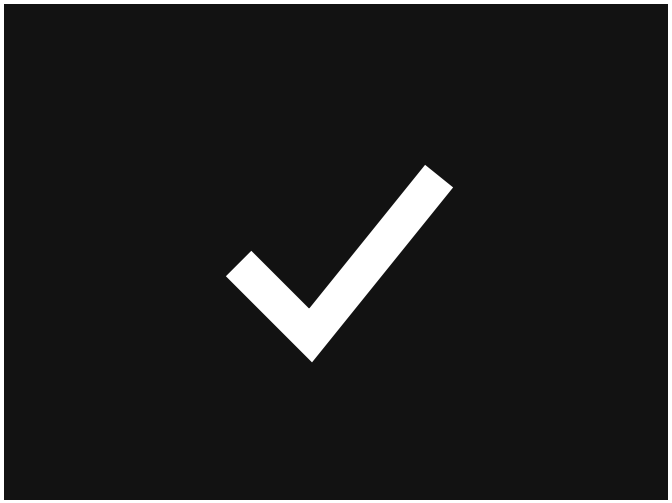
One line names the change. Fine print moves to the bottom.

Check on site 23 mm QR on a real gate scanner.

Gate screen







A problem says where to get help. Staff give the reason in private.

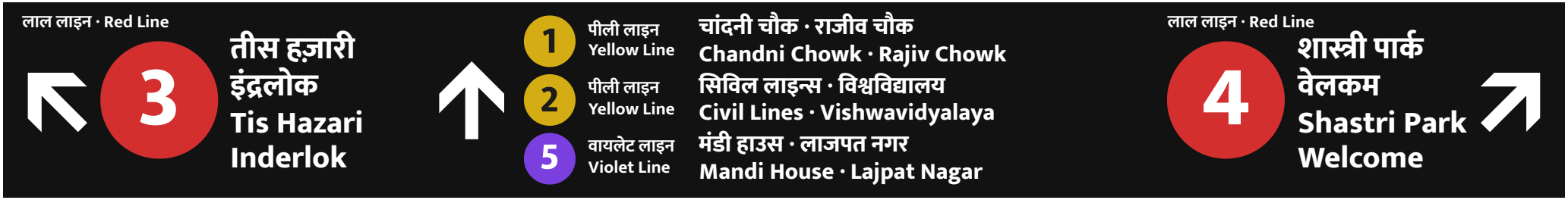
A good QR scan shows a tick and the first platform.

A good card tap shows only a tick. No balance is displayed.

Check on site Gate screen size and DMRC’s real error reasons.

Concourse

Fork sign, static



Long bar at the point where riders split.

Each platform has one arrow, one circle and two stops.

Directions match where the stairs really are.

Fork sign, live

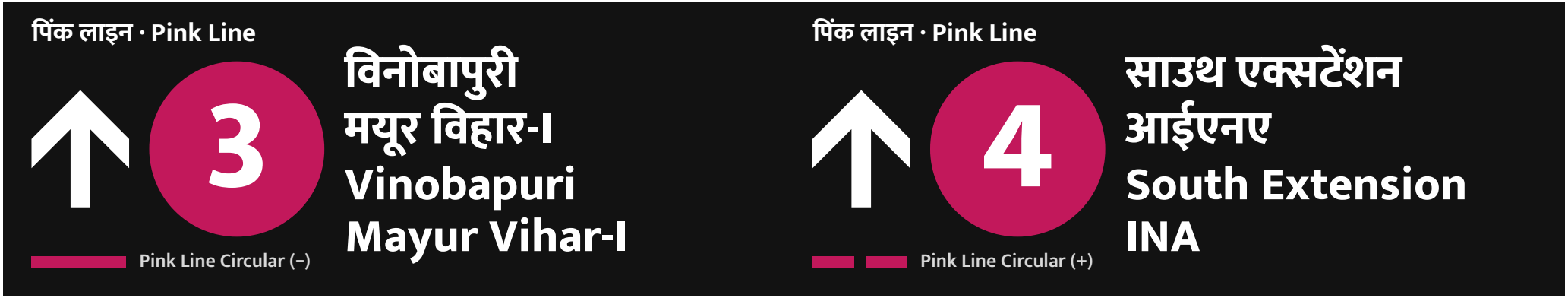


Same layout as the static sign, with minutes added.

Static signs stay. Screens only add live information.

No motion, except a new alert appearing.

Stair head sign



Two platforms side by side, split by direction.

Line name in the top strip.

Two stops per platform, stacked by script.

Platform totem



Platform circle beside the sign's two named stops.

Every station ahead with its stop count, on one left edge.

Repeats along the platform.

Check on site Totem size and directions on each platform.

Totem on an island platform



Split left and right, one half for each track.

Each half matches the train on its own side.

Same platform circle and stops, without the station list.

Check on site Which track each platform serves.

Station name on the wall



Name only, at window height.

Repeated about every coach length.

Readable from inside the train.

Platform

Stations ahead

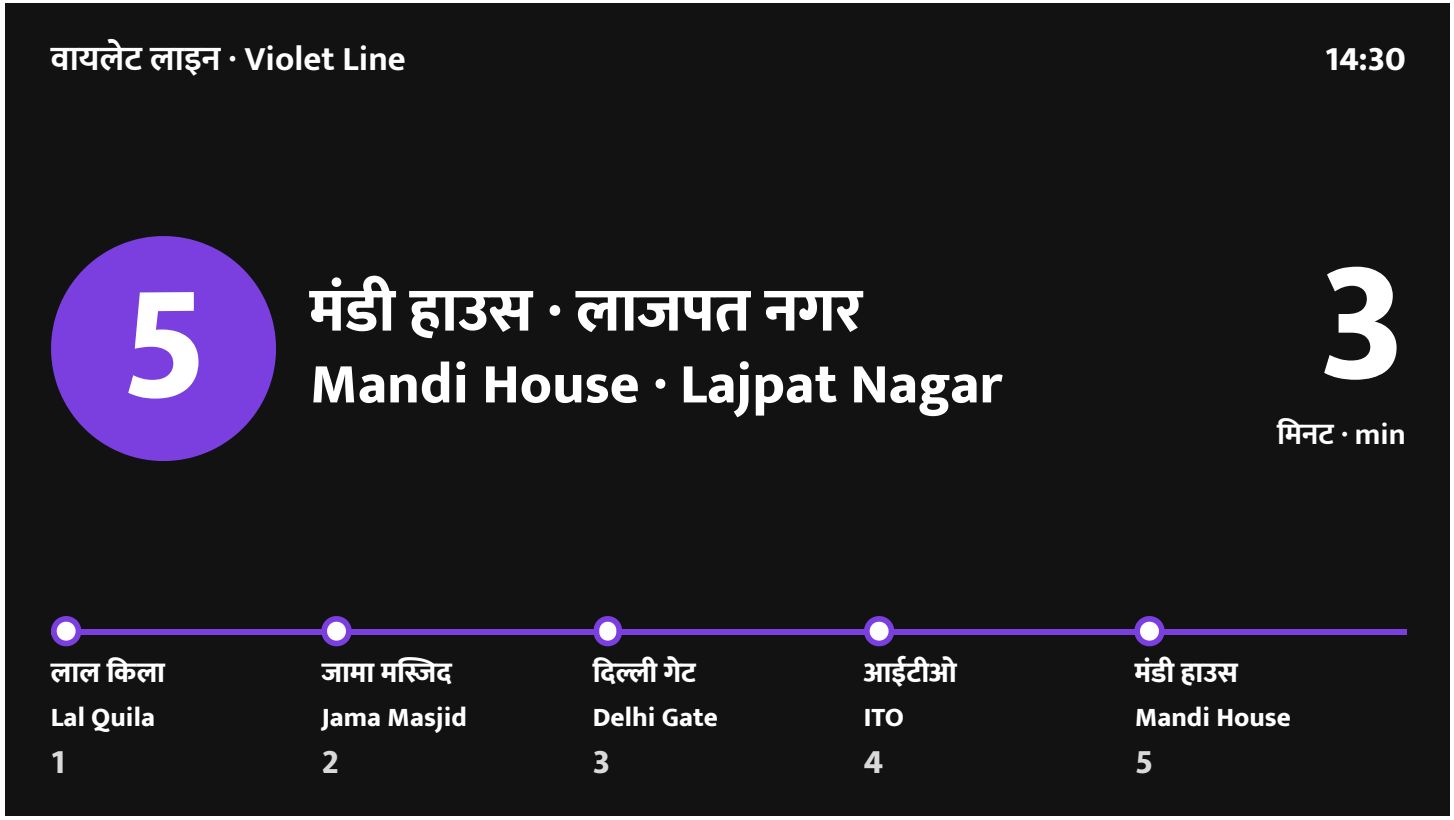


Every station ahead, in order.

Line bars mark the interchanges.

Numbered, so riders can count down.

Platform screen

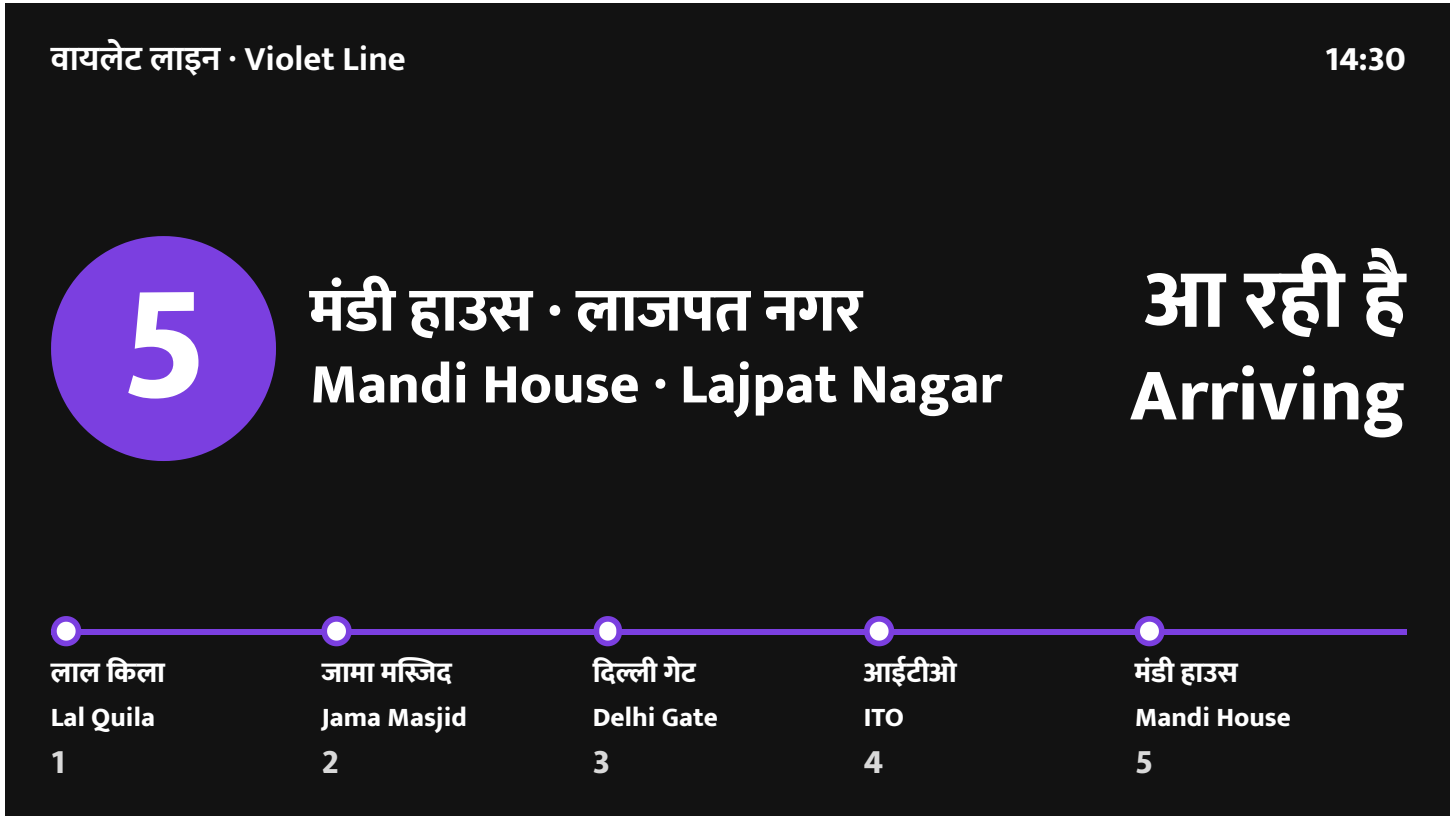


Next train, with the stops ahead.

16:9, in Hindi and English together.

No coach information.

Platform screen, train arriving



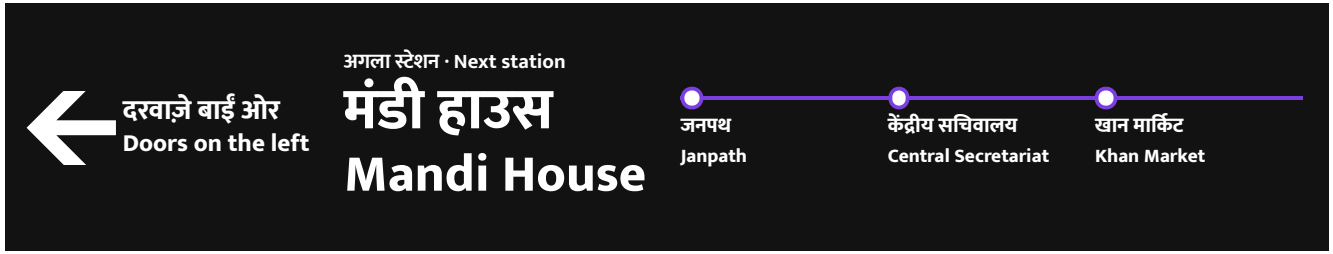
The word Arriving replaces the minutes.

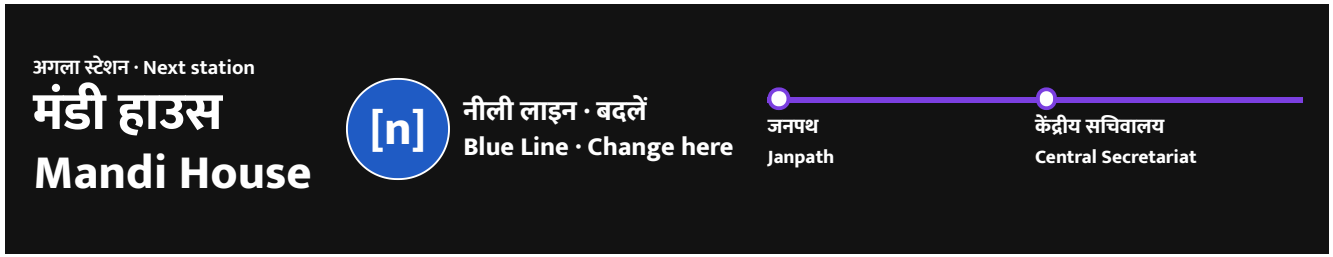
Nothing else on the screen changes.

Shown only as the train comes in.

In the train

Door displays







Next station and stops ahead, above every door.

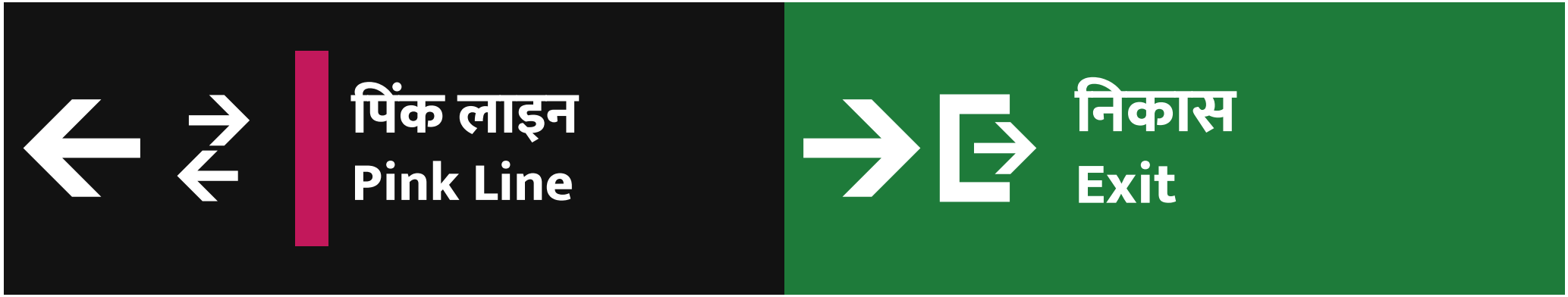
Door side shown with an arrow and in words.

At interchanges, platform key if data allows. Station takes over on arrival.

Check on site Door sides for each station.

Change signs



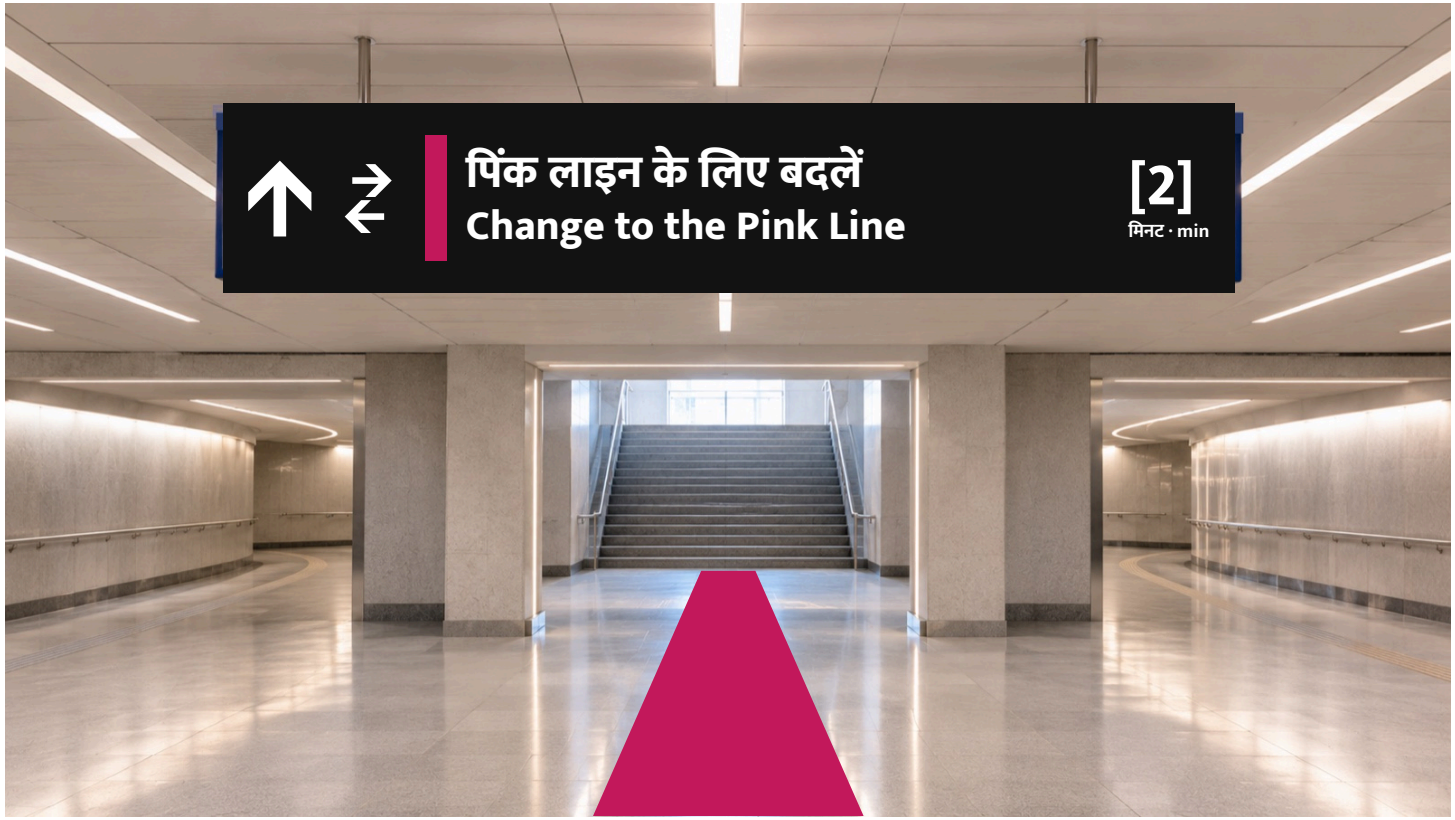


The first sign names only the line to follow.

Platforms split at the stair head.

Change and exit share one panel.

Floor path and walk time



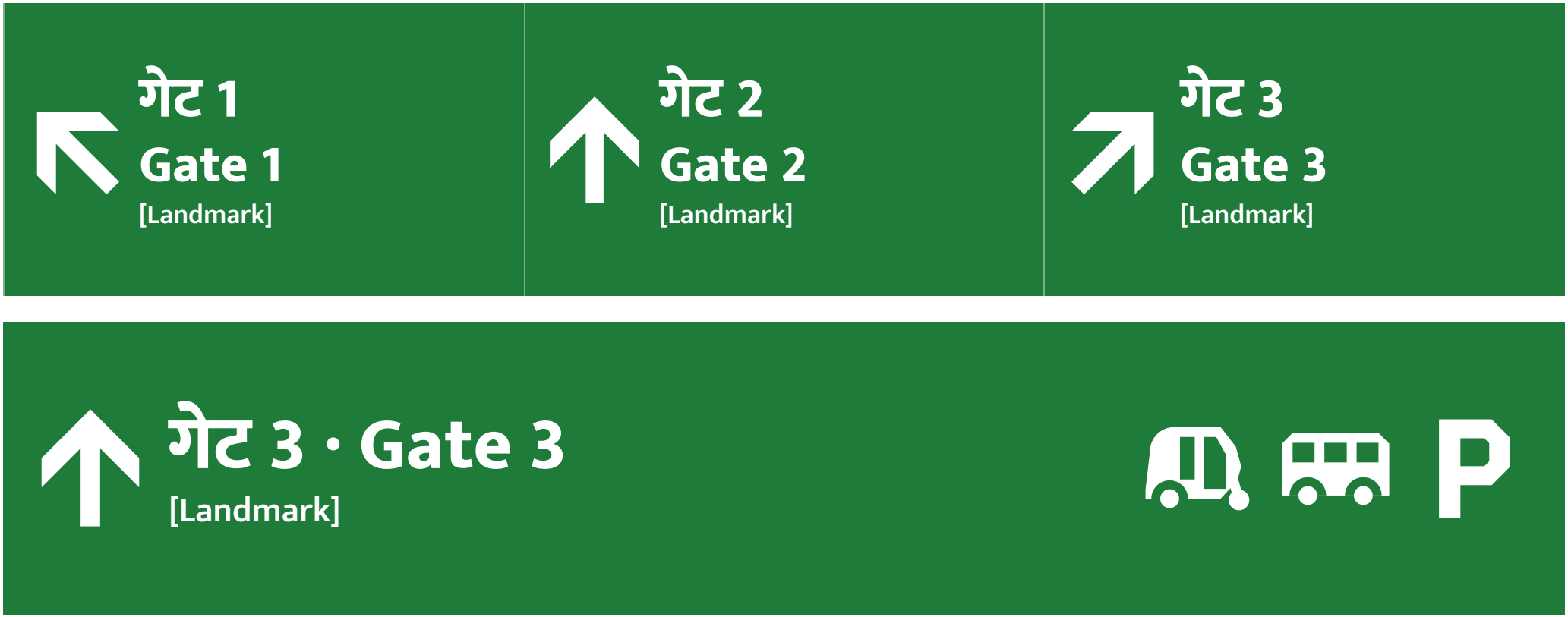
A line-colour floor path, unbroken along the corridor.

Long walks are shown in minutes.

At 3+ line stations, lines group by direction.

Check on site Walk times at each interchange.

Exit fork and gate



Exit is the only green panel.

Each gate is listed with its arrow and a landmark.

DMRC gate numbers are kept.

Check on site Landmarks at each gate.

Places by gate

आस-पास की जगहें · Places nearby

[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 1 · Gate 1
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 3 · Gate 3
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 1 · Gate 1
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 3 · Gate 3
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 1 · Gate 1
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 3 · Gate 3

[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 2 · Gate 2
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 4 · Gate 4
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 2 · Gate 2
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 4 · Gate 4
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 2 · Gate 2
[स्थान] [Place name]	गेट 4 · Gate 4

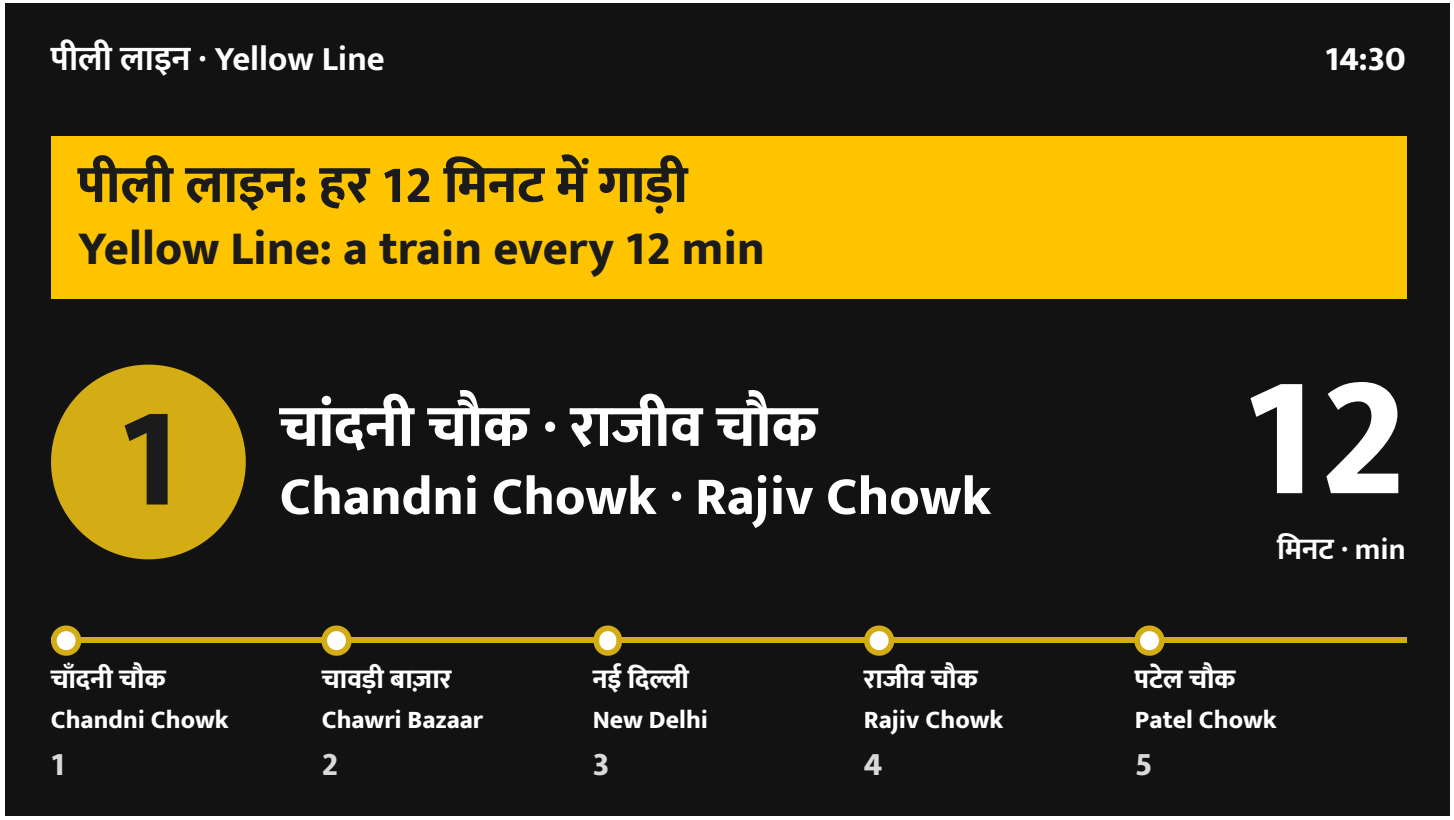
Nearby places are listed by gate.

Onward transport appears only at the gate that has it.

Names shown are placeholders.

Check on site Places and transport at each gate.

Service change



A yellow strip states what is happening to this train.

It says what is true, not what to do.

The platform number and stops stay put.

Affected rows on the fork

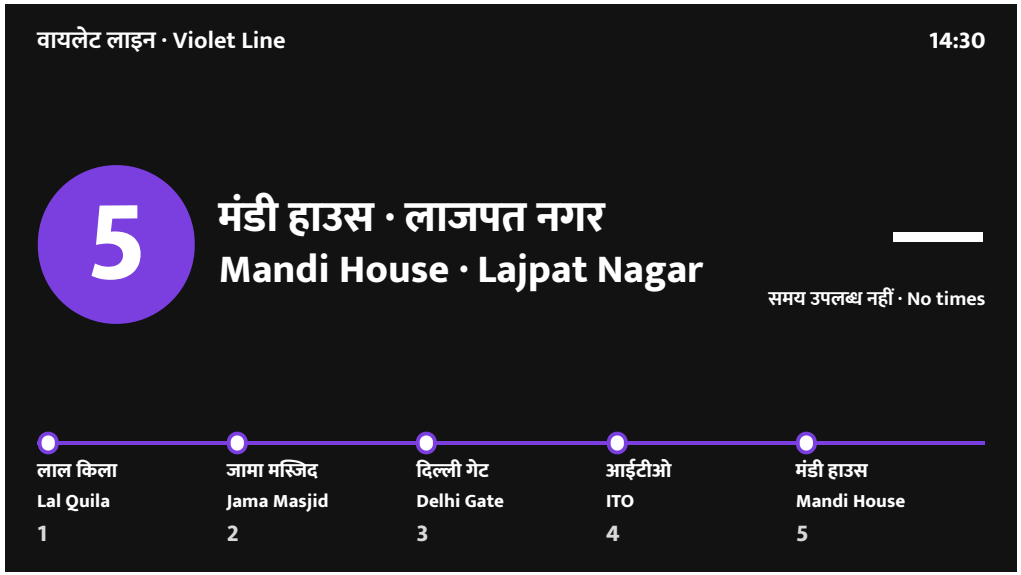


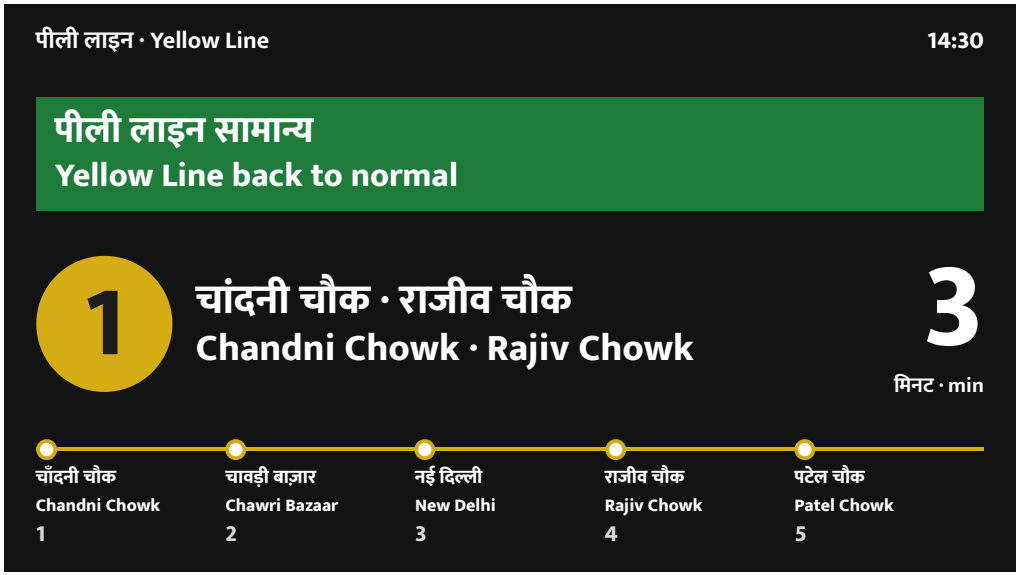
Only the affected rows are marked.

Other platforms carry on as normal.

Marked in alert yellow.

Missing times and recovery





If times are missing, the screen says so.

A short Back to normal notice follows recovery.

Neither one invents a time.

Emergency



The only full-screen state.

Uses exit green.

Exact wording must come from DMRC.

Check on site DMRC's emergency wording.

To check on site

- Real DMRC panel sizes
- Ceiling heights and the 2.4 m lowest edge
- Platform totem directions
- Which track each platform serves
- Yellow Line platform details
- Train door sides
- Walk times at interchanges
- Landmarks, places and transport by gate
- Gate screen size
- 23 mm QR on a real scanner
- DMRC’s gate error reasons
- DMRC’s emergency wording
- Native check of all new Hindi
- Rider testing of pictograms and black panels

What this does and does not claim

Tested	Not tested	Out of scope
An earlier white sign raised right first try from 45% to 80%, in an online test.	Night panel has not been tested with riders. A re-test is built but on hold.	Blind and low-vision navigation by sound and touch. This needs its own research.
That test relied on recall and had no station map.	Pictograms, screens and the new ticket are untested.	See MetroInSight (Bhave, San, Sharma, 2023) for work on this in DMRC.
	Nothing has been installed in a station.	

Thanks to: Digital Wayfinding Manual for WMATA (Order, W&CO). Revamping DMRC Ticketing System (Mathur, Maitra, Sharma, 2023). AIGA/DOT symbols. Mukta by Ek Type.